



Six kingdoms

EUBACTERIA



Types of organism: Simple single-celled bacteria

Distribution: Worldwide

Bacteria are found in all environments and conditions. They range from the cyanobacteria (blue-green algae), that first put oxygen into Earth's atmosphere, to organisms that cause diseases, such as typhoid or cholera. Useful types of bacteria can turn milk into yogurt or dirty water into clean water.

ARCHAEBACTERIA

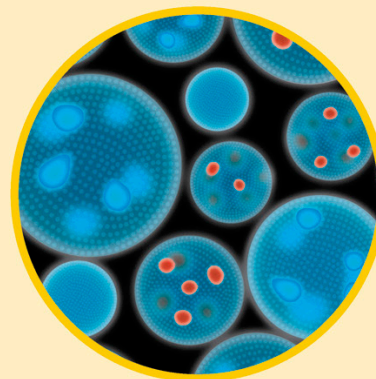


Types of organism: Simple single-celled bacteria

Distribution: Hostile environments

Archaeobacteria are thought to be among the oldest types of living organisms on the planet. They survive in some of the most hostile conditions imaginable—boiling water, radioactive waste, and acid or alkaline pools—similar to those that existed when Earth first formed.

PROTISTS



Types of organism: Slime molds, algae, protozoa

Distribution: Mainly marine or freshwater, sometimes land

Also known as the “odds and ends kingdom,” members of the protist group are all different. They are microscopic organisms, but they are not bacteria, plants, fungi, or animals. Although they are single cells, they have a nucleus. They make their own food or feed on other organisms.

Splitting up the species

Kingdoms are very broad groups, so scientists split them up into smaller and smaller groups until they get to one single type of organism, which they call a species. They divide each

group according to how similar or different the members are, and what they share in common. The classification for a lion looks like this:

